

Toh 814 in the Kangyur is a devotional verse text composed as a homage and aspir

Toh 814 · Derge Kangyur

Toh 814 in the Kangyur is a devotional verse text composed as a homage and aspirational prayer (smon lam) invoking the buddhas of the past, beginning with prostrations to the blessed buddhas and naming a sequence of victors—such as Vipasyin dwelling in nirvāṇa and the buddha Śikhin before the white lotus—each associated with a place of realization or activity. Structured as a litany, it moves through the succession of ancient buddhas, praising their qualities and deeds as a means of generating merit and setting forth aspirations tied to their example. Though its original Sanskrit title is not preserved in the source material, its Tibetan designation identifies it simply as a smon lam, or aspirational prayer, a genre common in the Kangyur for liturgical and devotional use. Belonging to the broader class of praise and aspiration literature found among the sūtra-related texts of the Kangyur, this short work exemplifies the tradition of invoking multiple buddhas in sequence as a devotional and ritual practice.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.